

NOVOGENIA · AKADEMIE

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS BURNOUT AND STRESS

Answers to typical client questions about genetic stress and burnout predisposition.

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This FAQ collection answers the most common client questions about the genetic stress and burnout analysis — what COMT and BDNF mean, how Warrior and Worrier types differ, and what concrete recommendations follow.

GENETIC BASIS OF STRESS

What is the COMT gene and why is it important?

COMT (Catechol-O-Methyltransferase) breaks down dopamine, adrenaline, and noradrenaline in the prefrontal cortex. A common variant (Val158Met) determines how fast this breakdown happens — by a factor of 3-4 between fast and slow variants. This regulates how long a stress signal stays in the system.

What is the difference between Warrior and Worrier?

Warrior (Val/Val): dopamine is broken down fast — more resistant to acute stress, performs under pressure. Worrier (Met/Met): dopamine is broken down slowly — concentration-strong in daily life but vulnerable to chronic stress. About 50% are mixed type.

What about BDNF?

BDNF (Brain-Derived Neurotrophic Factor) supports neuron growth and resilience. The Met-variant (Val66Met) reduces BDNF secretion; carriers recover more slowly from stress and are more vulnerable to depression under chronic strain. BDNF can be raised by exercise, sleep, learning, intermittent fasting.

PRACTICAL ADVICE

I am a Worrier — am I doomed to burn out?

No. The slow COMT variant raises sensitivity, not destiny. Knowing the predisposition lets you act early: clear recovery routines, sleep priority, breathing or meditation, avoid stacking many stressors at once. Over years this prevents the system from running into chronic overload.

I am a Warrior — do I still need to worry about burnout?

Lower acute risk, but recovery still matters. A feeling of "stress-free" can mask under-stimulation in quiet periods. Plan structure for concentration phases and protect sleep.

What helps everyone, regardless of genotype?

Sleep (7-9 h), regular movement (especially endurance — raises BDNF and regulates cortisol), social contact, meaning at work, and avoiding stimulant abuse (alcohol, excessive caffeine).

WHAT TO DO WITH THE RESULT

A "red zone" came up in my report. Should I be worried?

No. A red zone marks elevated risk in one specific area, not a diagnosis. It is an invitation to act early — exactly the opposite of a fatalistic verdict.

Where do I find concrete recommendations for my genotype?

In the burnout report — it contains detailed recommendations on meditation, nutrition, movement, sleep hygiene, and coping strategies, tailored to your individual COMT profile and the other evaluated factors.